

【8.31| The Guardian】 More than 3,000 high street firms appear to be shells **laundering money** 超 3000 家商业街企业疑为空壳洗钱公司

难度评级：★★★★☆☆

【考研那些事儿之英国系列】

今日文章脉络：

英国商业街大量美容店和便利店被指为洗钱工具 (Para. 1)



这些公司存续时长短且集中于特定区域 (Para. 2-3)



英国公司注册制度遭受质疑，政府采取相关行动 (Para. 4-5)



下议院财政委员会会议上专家揭露问题根源，
贪图便宜快捷引发其他问题 (Para. 6-8)



SmartSearch 研究分析揭示规律：集中注册、集中注销 (Para.9-12)



CEO 表明这是公开运作的非法模式，
改革速度赶不上犯罪的加速扩张 (Para.13)



保守估计涉案金额超 3 亿英镑，
拓展至高风险行业总金额或超 10 亿英镑 (Para.14)

【学习流程：第一遍请先看原文自己精读，第二遍对照着本精读文档进行理解。文章标注的单词为重点单词，只提供相关注释，想要详细释义麻烦同学查一下词典哦！另外文章底色为灰色的句子为今天的翻译作业，今日文档中的句子分析模块会提供答案，同学们请先思考再看句子分析~】

【Para.1】

Up to £464m has “moved through” more than 3,000 UK shell companies branded as beauty and convenience stores but apparently operating in the money– laundering and terrorist financing sectors, a new analysis **sets out**.

- **launder v.** /'lɔ:ndə(r)/ to move money that has been obtained illegally into foreign bank accounts or legal businesses so that it is difficult for people to know where the money came from 洗（钱）

Organized crime groups launder their profits through anonymous companies. 有组织的犯罪极端利用匿名公司洗黑钱。

- **set out phrase** to present ideas, facts, etc. in an organized way, in speech or writing (有条理地) 陈述，阐明 【考研大纲词汇】

He set out his objections to the plan. 他陈述了他对这个计划的反对意见。

一项新分析指出，高达 4.64 亿英镑的资金“流经”3000 多家英国空壳公司。这些公司对外标榜为美容店和便利店，但实际上却从事洗钱和恐怖主义融资活动。

【Para.2】

The companies — some listed as hairdressers, barber shops and salons, others as mini-marts and corner shops — show “remarkably similar **lifespans**” of about six months despite their seemingly different purposes.

- **lifespan** n./ 'laɪfspæn/ the length of time that sth is likely to live, continue or function 寿命；可持续年限；有效期

Worms have a lifespan of a few months. 蠕虫的寿命为几个月。

这些公司——有些登记为美发店、理发店和美容院，另一些则是小型超市和街角商店——尽管经营目的看似不同，但它们的“存续周期”却惊人的相似，大约都为六个月。

【Para.3】

They are also “heavily **concentrated** in a small number of areas”, according to the research by the anti-money-laundering software provider SmartSearch.

- **concentrate** v. /kɒnsntreɪt/ to bring sth together in one place 使...集中（或集合、聚集）【考研大纲词汇】

Power is largely concentrated in the hands of a small elite. 权力主要

集中在少数精英人物的手里。

根据反洗钱软件公司 SmartSearch 的研究, 这些公司还“高度集中在少数几个地区”。

【Para.4】

The findings come amid increased scrutiny of the **integrity** of the UK company register, with many experts arguing that a **proliferation** of **off- the- shelf** businesses shows how bad actors are exploiting the system for money laundering and tax **evasion**.

- **integrity** n./in'tegrəti/ (formal) the state of being whole and not divided 完整；完好

to respect the territorial integrity of the nation 尊重该国的领土完整

SYN unity
- **proliferation** n. /prəˌlifə'reɪʃn/ the sudden increase in the number or amount of sth; a large number of a particular thing 激增；增殖；增生；大量的事物

attempts to prevent cancer cell proliferation 防止癌细胞扩散的努力
- **off- the- shelf** adj. (of products) that can be bought immediately and does not have to be specially designed or ordered 现成的；从货架直接取下买走的

off-the-shelf software packages 现货软件包

- **evasion n.** /ɪ'veɪʒn/ the act of avoiding sb or of avoiding sth that you are supposed to do 躲避；规避；逃避；回避

She's been charged with tax evasion. 她被控逃税。

该研究结果出现之际，英国企业登记册的可信性正受到越来越严密的审查；许多专家认为，现成空壳公司的激增说明不法分子正利用该制度进行洗钱和逃税。

【Para.5】

This month, Andy Burnham announced plans to give **councils** new powers to stop betting and **vape** shops **taking over** their high streets, while in May the government said a new specialist unit would target “**dodgy**” retail outlets such as vape stores and sweet shops that are suspected of being used to launder £1bn of criminal money.

- **council n.** /'kaʊnsl/ a group of people who are elected to govern an area such as a city or county （市、郡等的）政务委员会，地方议会
a city/town/district/borough council 市 / 镇 / 区 / 自治市政务委员会
- **vape n.** /veɪp/ an electronic device, similar to an E-CIGARETTE, that produces VAPOUR, usually containing NICOTINE, that you can

take into your lungs through your mouth 电子烟

I've never tried a vape. 我从没抽过电子烟。

- **take over** *phrase* to begin to have control of or responsibility for sth, especially in place of sb else 接替；接任；接管；接手【考研大纲词汇】

Paul's daughter took over the job in 2017. 保罗的女儿于 2017 年接手这一工作。

- **dodgy** *adj.* /'dɒdʒi/ seeming or likely to be dishonest 狡猾的；狡诈的；可疑的

He made a lot of money, using some very dodgy methods. 他采用一些极其狡诈的手段赚了许多钱。

本月，安迪·伯纳姆宣布计划赋予地方议会新权力，以阻止博彩店和电子烟商店占领商业街；而在 5 月份，政府表示将成立一个新的专门部门，打击电子烟店和糖果店等“可疑”零售门店，这些店铺涉嫌被用来洗白 10 亿英镑的犯罪所得。

【Para.6】

The topic was given more attention during a House of Commons Treasury committee meeting in June, when Paul Monaghan, the chief executive of the Fair Tax Foundation, told MPs: “There is a reason that we have a company register full of

hundreds of thousands of **fraudsters**.

- **fraudster** n./'frɔ:dstə(r)/ a person who commits fraud 犯诈骗罪者；
犯欺骗罪者

That data could someday be sold on the black market to medical **fraudsters**. 这些数据有一天可能会在黑市上被卖给医疗欺诈者。

今年6月，在下议院财政委员会的一次会议上，这一话题受到了更多关注。公平税收基金会首席执行官保罗·莫纳汉对议员们表示：“我们的公司注册册里充斥着数十万诈骗分子，这是有原因的。”

【Para.7】

“The **Insolvency** Service has just recently **shut down** five illegal company service providers, which between them had set up 12,000 illegal companies in the UK, and we are only halfway through the year.

- **insolvency** n. /ɪn'sɒlvənsi/ a situation in which a person or a company is insolvent 无力偿还，破产

One year later, Eik bank declared insolvency and was taken over by the state. 一年后，Eik 银行也宣布倒闭，被国家接管。

- **shut down** phrase to stop a factory, shop, etc. from opening for business; to stop a machine from working (使) 关张，停业，倒闭，

关闭，停止运转

The computer system will be shut down over the weekend. 计算机系统周末关闭。

“英国破产局近期刚刚关停五家非法企业服务供应商，这五家供应商合计在英国注册了 12000 家非法公司，而今年才刚过一半。”

【Para.8】

“We have got a problem in this country that the **obsession** to set it up cheap and quick creates all the other problems.”

- **obsession** n./əb'seʃn/ the state in which a person's mind is completely filled with thoughts of one particular thing or person in a way that is not normal 痴迷；着魔；困扰

Her fear of flying is bordering on obsession. 她怕乘飞机几乎到了不可救药的地步。

“我们国家存在一个问题：热衷于便宜、快捷地注册公司，而这滋生了其他问题。”

【Para.9】

The SmartSearch analysis of Companies House records

between 2016 and 2026 focused solely on the two business sectors of beauty and convenience stores.

SmartSearch 对 2016 年至 2026 年间公司注册处记录进行分析，
并仅将研究目标锁定在两个商业领域：美容店和便利店。

【Para.10】

It found 3,097 **dissolved** companies averaging 170 to 194 days of life, clustered into the same postcodes, the same registered addresses, and the same months of the year for **incorporation** and dissolution.

- **dissolve** v./di'zɒlv/ to officially end a marriage, business agreement or parliament 解除（婚姻关系）；终止（商业协议）；解散（议会）

Their marriage was dissolved in 1999. 他们于 1999 年解除了婚姻关系。

- **incorporation** n./ɪn,kɔ:pə'reɪʃn/ the process or fact of legally making a company into a corporation or part of a corporation 公司注册

But Delaware, the biggest state for incorporation, is on board, as is America's treasury secretary, Steven Mnuchin. 但最大的企业注册州，特拉华州以及美国财政部长史蒂文·努钦都支持立法。

分析发现，有 3097 家已注销的公司，平均存续时长为 170 至 194 天，它们有着相同的邮政编码、相同的注册地址，并且集

中在一年相同的月份进行注册和注销。

【Para.11】

The data also showed how 83% of suspect hairdressing companies and 92% of suspect convenience stores were incorporated in the first and second quarters of each year, with more than half dissolved in the fourth quarter.

数据还显示，83% 的可疑美发公司以及 92% 可疑便利店在每年第一和第二季度注册，其中超过一半会在第四季度完成注销。

【Para.12】

The cycle repeats annually across both sectors, the paper said, adding: “A single area of Cardiff contains 119 suspected companies on its own, across both sectors.”

报告称，这样的周期模式在这两个行业每年都重复，还补充提到：“仅加的夫的一片区域，这两个行业内就存在 119 家可疑公司。”

【Para.13】

Phil Cotter, the chief executive of SmartSearch, said: “This is

not a story about small businesses failing. It is a story about patterns that suggest a **repeatable** model of **exploitation** operating openly across UK high streets, and accelerating faster than the regulatory response has been able to catch. Companies House has made real progress since the Economic Crime and Corporate Transparency Act came into force. But the register still reveals patterns that suggest the **underlying** activity is running ahead of the pace of reform.”

- **repeatable** **adj.** /rɪ'pi:təbl/ that can be repeated 可重复

The Feynman technique breaks the learning process into four broad and repeatable steps. 费曼技巧将学习过程分为四个广泛且可重复的步骤。

- **exploitation** **n.** /,eksplɔɪ'teɪʃn/ the fact of using a situation in order to get an advantage for yourself （出于私利的）利用

exploitation of the situation for his own purposes 利用这种局势达到他自己的目的

- **underlying** **adj.** /,ʌndə'laɪɪŋ/ important in a situation but not always easily noticed or stated clearly 根本的；潜在的；隐含的

Unemployment may be an underlying cause of the rising crime rate. 失业可能是犯罪率攀升的潜在原因。

SmartSearch 首席执行官菲尔·科特表示：“这并非关乎小企业

的倒闭。这关乎的是一种模式。它表明一种可重复的利用模式正在英国商业街上公开运作，并且它扩张的速度已经超过监管反应所能跟上的速度。自《经济犯罪和企业透明度法案》生效以来，公司注册处（在打击犯罪以及提升企业信息透明度方面）已经取得了实质进展。但登记册仍显示出一些趋势，表明暗地里的（洗钱等非法金融）活动的步伐仍跑在改革前面。”

【Para.14】

The paper concludes: “The financial scale matters, and **conservative** modelling already suggests something between £310m and £464m has moved through these companies alone. Apply the same patterns across the other sectors named in the 2025 national risk assessment as high risk and the figure for the past decade likely sits above £1bn.”

- **conservative adj.** /kənˈsɜːvətɪv/ opposed to great or sudden social change; showing that you prefer traditional styles and values 保守的；守旧的

the conservative views of his parents 他父母的保守观念

报告总结道：“资金规模很重要，保守模型已经表明，仅这些公司就流经了 3.1 亿至 4.64 亿英镑。如果将同样的模式应用于 2025 年国家风险评估中列为高风险的其它行业，那么过去十年的

数字可能超过 10 亿英镑。”

25 August 2026 | The Guardian

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► 今日翻译作业

(Para.13) It is a story about patterns that suggest a repeatable model of exploitation operating openly across UK high streets, and accelerating faster than the regulatory response has been able to catch.

(下一页提供句子分析)

► 今日句子分析

(Para.13) It is a story about patterns that suggest a repeatable model of exploitation operating openly across UK high streets, and accelerating faster than the regulatory response has been able to catch. 这关乎的是一种模式。它表明一种可重复的利用模式正在英国商业街上公开运作，并且它扩张的速度已经超过监管反应所能跟上的速度。

主句

定语从句

It is a story about patterns that suggest

主语 系语

表语

主语

谓语

a repeatable model of exploitation operating openly

宾语

现在分词作后置定语

across UK high streets, and

状语

(连词)

比较状语从句

accelerating faster than the regulatory response

现在分词作后置定语

从句主语

has been able to catch.

系语

表语

句子分析：

主句：主系表结构，It 为主语，is 为系动词，story 为表语，about patterns 为介词短语作后置定语修饰 story。It 不指代具体事物，用于引出后面要阐述的情况；

定语从句：主语 that 指代先行词 patterns，在从句中充当主语；谓语 suggest；现在分词 operating 与 accelerating 并列，作定语共同修饰宾语 model of exploitation；

比较状语从句：

主语为 the regulatory response；has been able to catch 可以看作一个复合谓语；catch 此处为熟词僻义，表示“跟上、追及”，相当于 keep up with。

翻译解析：在考研英语的翻译和阅读理解中，经常喜欢考察此种复杂结构，考验考生能否抽丝剥茧，找到核心骨架。通过拆解分析此句，可以进一步了解的主系表结构下嵌套的定语从句（that suggest）、现在分词作后置定语（operating.../accelerating...）以及比较状语从句（faster than...）等核心知识点；此外该句逻辑清晰，用词凝练，体现出写作表达的高级感，是考研大作文社会批判类的优秀仿写例句。

► 写作积累

1. (Para.4)The findings come amid increased scrutiny of the integrity of the UK company register, with many experts arguing that a proliferation of off- the- shelf businesses shows how bad actors are exploiting the system for money laundering and tax evasion.

本句中的 amid 表示“在.....的背景下”、“在.....之中”，常用于描述环境或氛围，此外 proliferation of sth 表示.....的大量涌现，可作为写作素材积累替换简单词 many，它常用来描述某类事物在数量上快速、大规模地增加，通常用不可数形式。最常见结构：the proliferation of + 名词，例如可用来引出社会现象 Recent years have witnessed a proliferation of online learning platforms.近年来，在线学习平台大量涌现。此外，还有一些短语在写作中非常实用，可以表达类似的含义：

[?] a sharp rise in 例如 a sharp rise in unemployment 失业率的急剧上升，在图表作文中可用来描写趋势。

[?] an explosion in 例如 an explosion in data generation 数据生成的爆炸式增长，适用于在信息化背景下，形容信息、数据等方面，explosion 侧重于爆炸式、规模大。

[?] rapid growth in 例如 rapid growth in mobile payments 移动支付快速增长，rapid growth 侧重于范围广，偏中性，常用与经济发展、行业增长等语境。

2. (Para.13)But the register still reveals patterns that suggest the

underlying activity is running ahead of the pace of reform.”

本句中 run ahead of.. 表示“超越、走在.....前面”。在正式写作中，可用 run ahead of 替换简单的 exceed 或 surpass，增加表达多样性。另外，注意与 run ahead 的区别，run ahead 单独使用表示“跑在前面”，例如 He ran ahead.他跑在前面；而 run ahead of 必须接宾语，表示“领先于”，例如 He ran ahead of the others.他跑在其他人前面。以下还有其他表达类似含义的短语：

- ❓ **be ahead of sb/sth.** 强调状态，静态的领先；而 run ahead of 更强调动态过程。例如：Our company is ahead of its competitors in AI research.我们公司在人工智能研究方面领先于竞争对手。
- ❓ **in advance of** 表示“在.....之前”，只表示时间上的“先于”，没有“领先程度”的含义。例如：Please notify us in advance of any changes.如有任何变动，请提前通知我们。